ZUKUNFT LAND

Havelland

Full data report

Generated 2026-11-04

Brandenburg

NUTS-3 regions: DE408



Figure 1: The Havelland Living Lab: study region (left) and its location within Germany (right). Basemap: Tiles © Esri - Source: Esri, i-cubed, USDA, USGS, AEX, GeoEye, Getmapping, Aerogrid, IGN, IGP, UPR-EGP, and the GIS User Community

Agriculture

Key figures

CROPLAND AREA	NUMBER OF FARMS	AVERAGE FARM SIZE	SHARE OF ORGANIC FARMING
58,936 ha	**355** count	**252** ha	**14.1** %

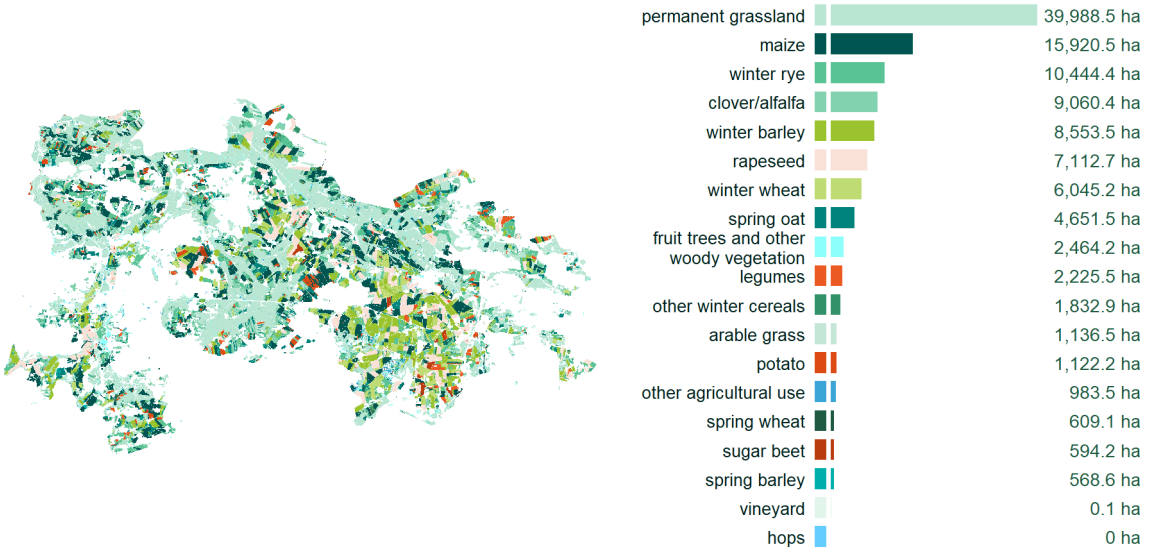


Figure 2: Map showing Agriculture in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Crop types (DLR, 2024))

Overview

Agriculture and livestock farming characterise large areas of the Havelland region. Over 80% of agricultural land is farmed by businesses, who own more than 100 ha farmland each. Small businesses account for just 3.6% of the area. Due to the high proportion of grassland in the region, cattle, horse and sheep farming are particularly important. A wide variety of crops are grown, from rye and barley to maize, potatoes, high-quality wheat and beet. Parts of the Havelländische Luch are also attractive for arable farming due to their proximity to groundwater.

Challenges

Agriculture in the Havelland district is characterised by location and land conditions (wetlands, predominance of grassland, varying soil quality) and is simultaneously subject to growing external demands (animal welfare, biodiversity, environmental protection, economic efficiency, climate change, and in the east of the region: land use pressure from competing land users). The combination of different uses (arable land, grassland, animal husbandry) and coordination with water/soil/nature conservation associations make the situation complex. Water management requirements clash with outdated water regulation technology.

Climate

Key figures

GROWING DEGREE DAYS, ANNUAL SUM (BASE 5 °C)	MEAN ANNUAL TEMPERATURE	ANNUAL PRECIPITATION	PRECIPITATION OF WARMEST QUARTER
2,033 °C·d +1,139 °C·d by 2071-2100	**9.5** °C +4 °C by 2071-2100	**584** mm +2.6 % by 2071-2100	**181** mm -6.4 % by 2071-2100

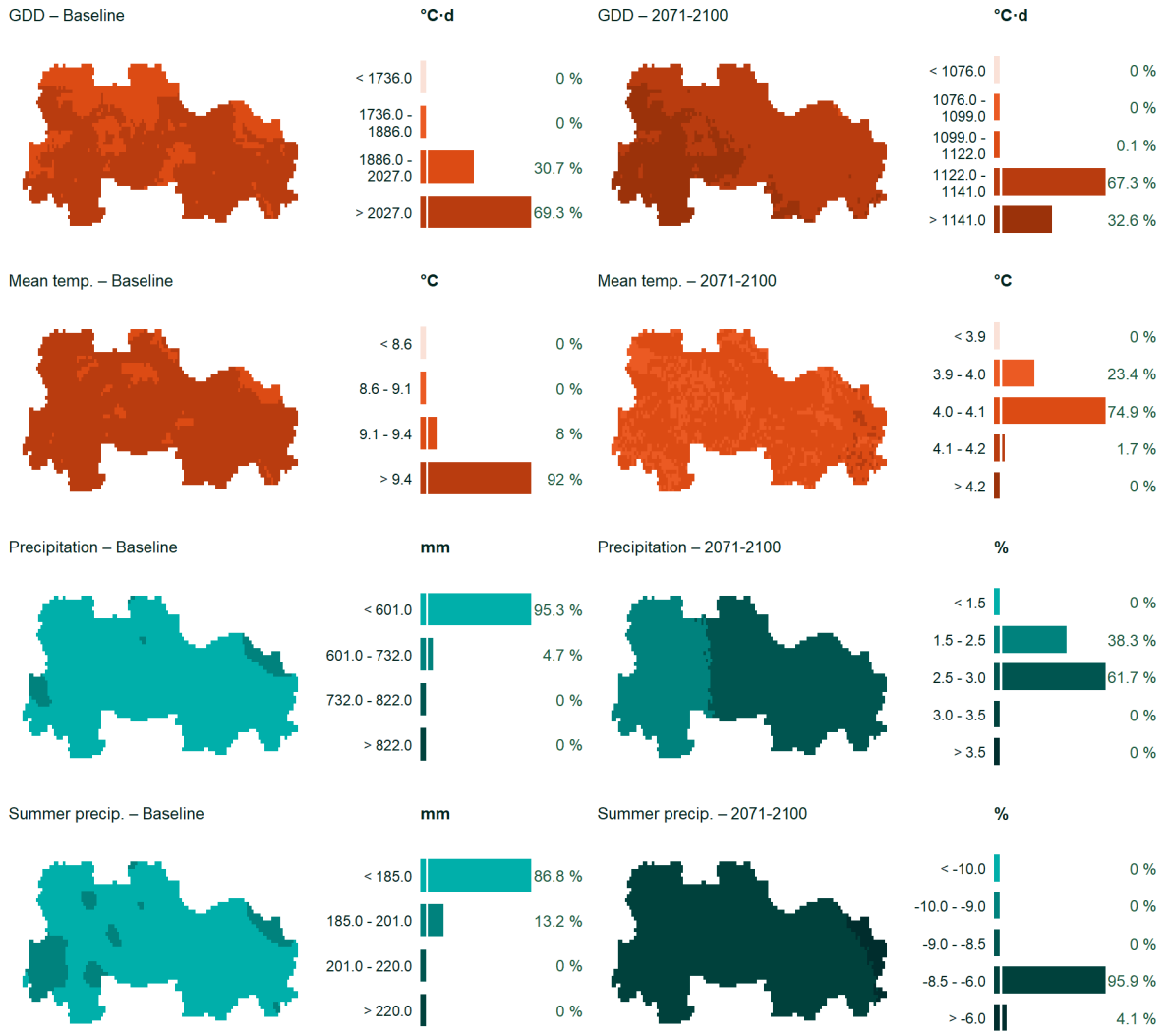


Figure 3: Map showing Climate in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Climate (CHELSA V2.1 / CMIP6): Growing degree days, Mean annual temperature, Annual precipitation, Precipitation of warmest quarter)

Heat accumulated above 5 °C over the year - a measure of how much growing season a crop gets.
Mean annual air temperature, averaged over the reference period.
Total precipitation summed over the year.
Precipitation falling in the warmest three-month quarter - relevant to summer drought stress.

Havelland

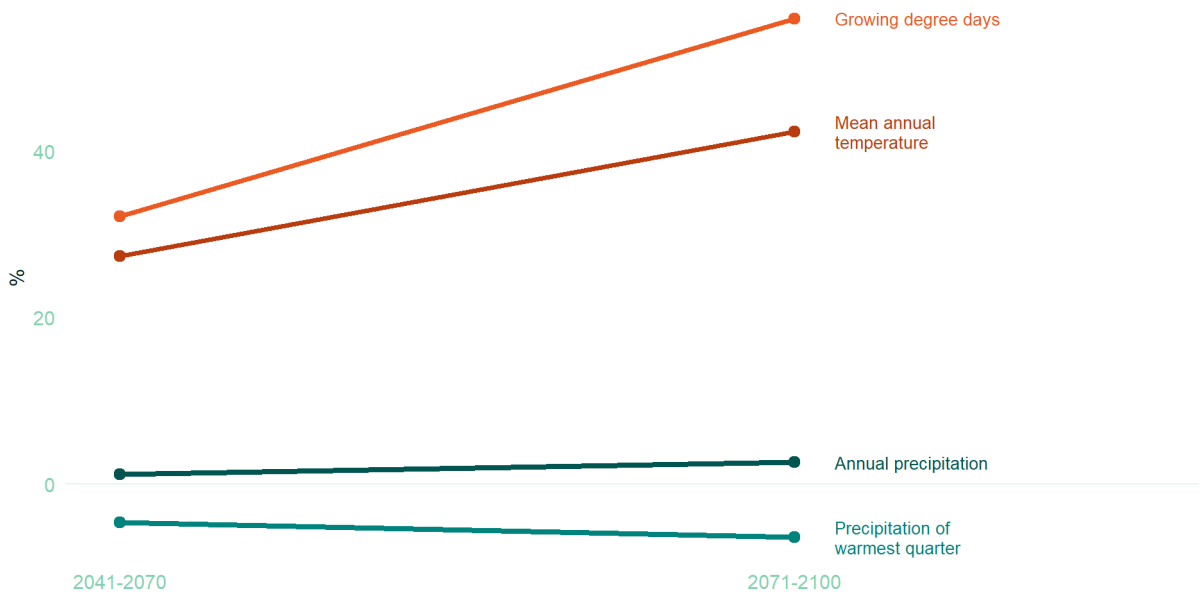


Figure 4: Chart showing Climate in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Climate (CHELSA V2.1 / CMIP6): Growing degree days, Mean annual temperature, Annual precipitation, Precipitation of warmest quarter)

Overview

The Havelland district is still considered part of the North-East German lowlands, with influences of maritime climates. Summers are relatively warm, and summer precipitation levels of 250-350 mm are slightly higher than during the rest of the year. In winter, which can be considered mild to moderately cold on average, there are more days with precipitation than in summer, but with lower total precipitation levels.

Challenges

Due to increasing evaporation, the climatic water balance in the area under consideration is generally deteriorating. This is particularly evident in summer and is a development that will become increasingly significant in the future. In the Havelland region, too, annual precipitation is increasingly concentrated in heavy rain events, which are interrupted by ever-longer periods of drought.

Soil

Key figures

NITROGEN SURPLUS	PHOSPHORUS SURPLUS	GROUNDWATER ABSTRACTION (NON-PUBLIC SUPPLY)
No data available kg N/ha UAA	**No data available** kg P/ha UAA	**956** 1000 m3

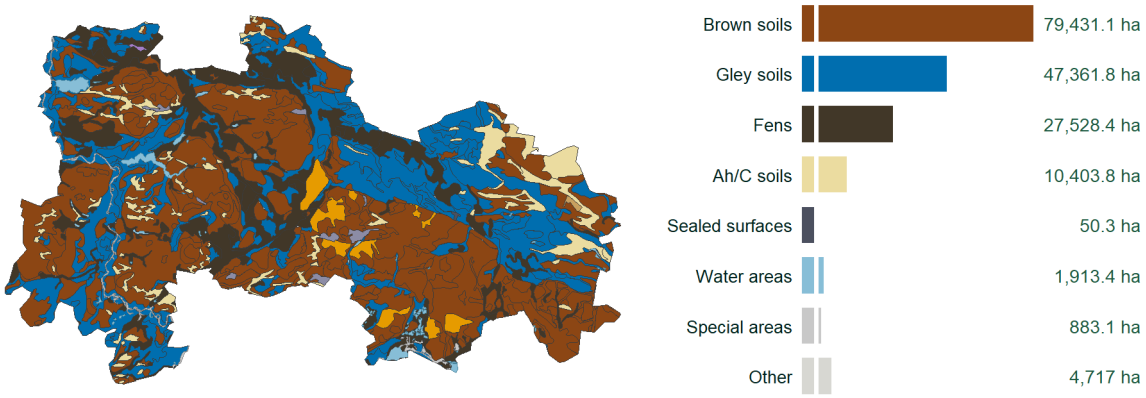


Figure 5: Map showing Soil in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Soil overview map (BUEK250))
Legend shows the dominant semantic soil groups for this Living Lab; raw BUEK IDs stay in the data only as provenance.

Overview

Havelland is classified as part of the North German inland lowlands and has sandy, diluvial soils. The quality of the arable soil increases from west to east. The Havelland region still has approximately 28,000 hectares of peatland. Compared to the rest of Germany, nitrate contamination of the soil is relatively low.

Challenges

As in other German regions, the soils of the agricultural areas in the Havelland are also affected by degradation. In many places, the peat soils have been irreversibly degraded as a result of decades of landscape drainage.

Socio-economic

Key figures

TOTAL POPULATION	GDP PER CAPITA	UNEMPLOYMENT RATE	DISPOSABLE HOUSEHOLD INCOME PER CAPITA
169,721 persons	26,345 EUR	6.7 %	26,615 EUR

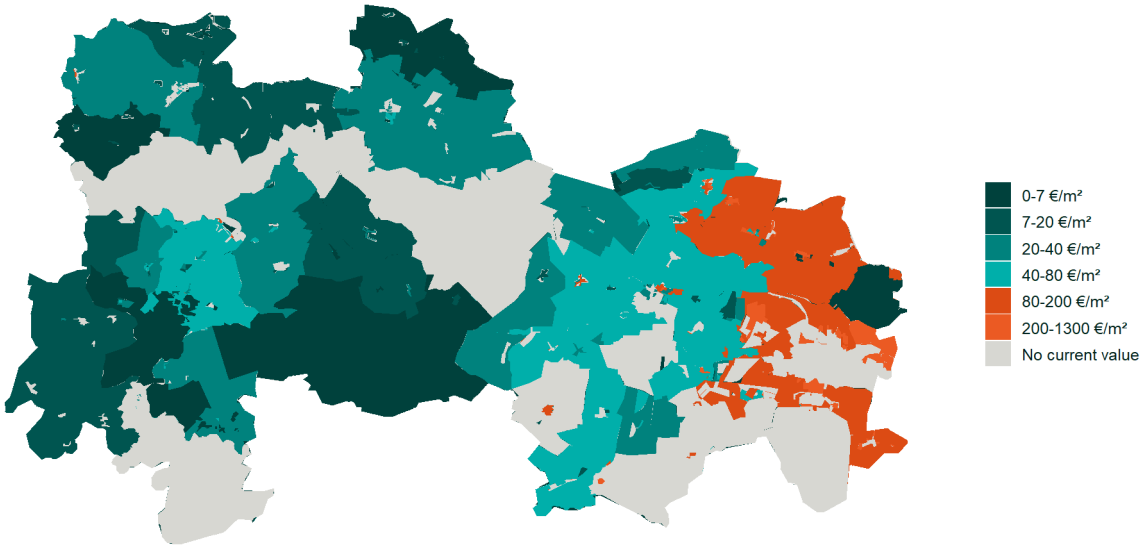


Figure 6: Map showing Socio-economic in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Standard land values (BORIS))

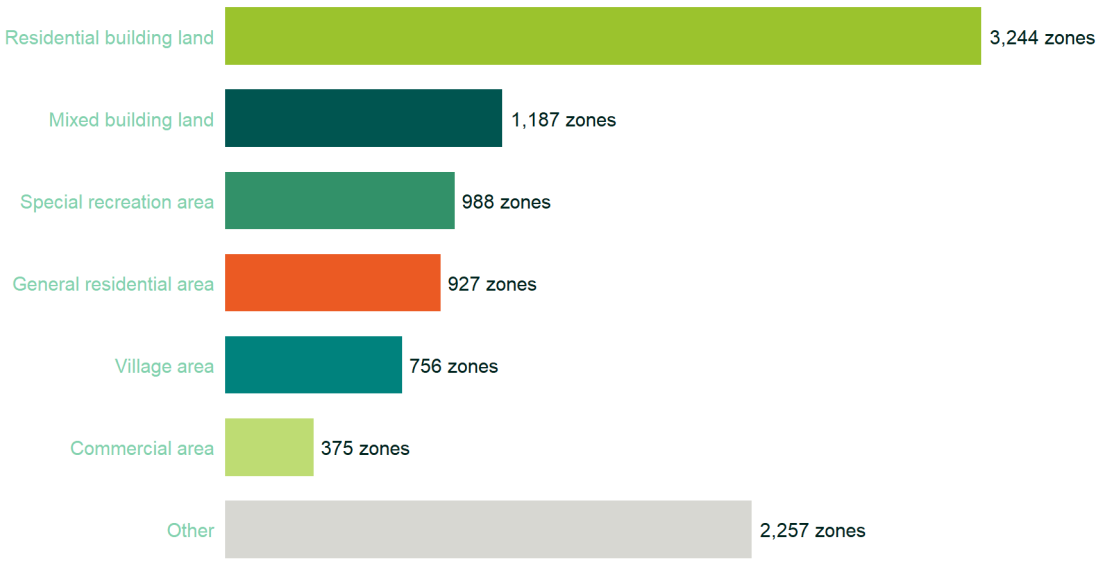


Figure 7: Chart showing Socio-economic in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Standard land values (BORIS))

Overview

The socio-economic situation of the Havelland region is strongly influenced by its proximity to Berlin, with the eastern part of the region, which is close to the city, differing significantly from the rural western part. The population and building density is much higher in the east. The towns of Falkensee and Nauen, which are close to Berlin, have grown rapidly in recent years, and the district is among the top 15 in Germany in terms of positive net migration. Most industrial companies (especially in the logistics sector) are also located in the east of the district. The importance of tourism (especially water tourism) has increased recently. The unemployment rate is relatively low compared to the rest of the state. However, household incomes are among the lowest in Germany.

Challenges

Agriculture in the Havelland region is undergoing structural change. The region's traditional extensive grassland farming, with its livestock herds, is in a phase of decline. New, lucrative business models for managing wet meadows are being sought. Successors are urgently needed for the farm operations—some of which are very large—that date back to the GDR era. The market advantages offered by the nearby Berlin metropolitan region for increased regional production and sales are not yet being fully exploited.

Landscape

Key figures

FOREST AREA	NATURA 2000 AREA	NATURE RESERVES AREA	SHARE OF SEALED SURFACE
44,150 ha	66,311.2 ha	21,153 ha	11 %

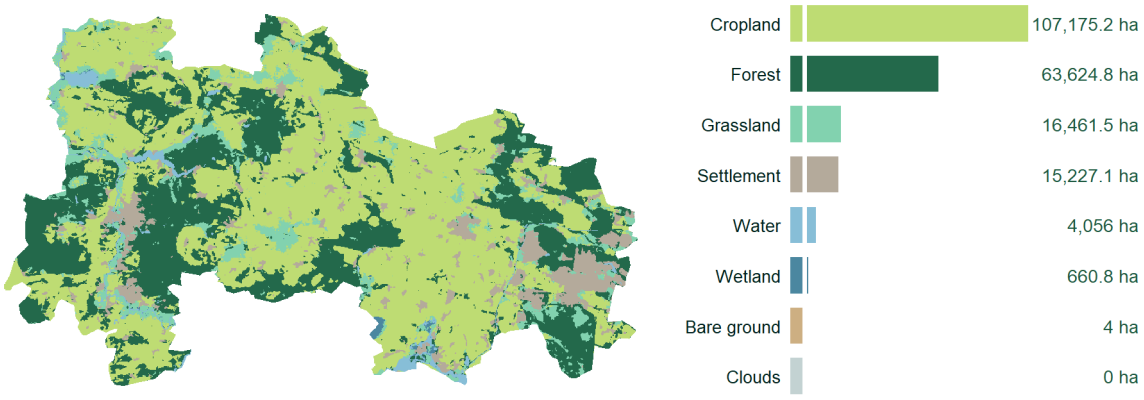


Figure 8: Map showing Landscape in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Land cover (Esri/Impact Observatory, 2024))

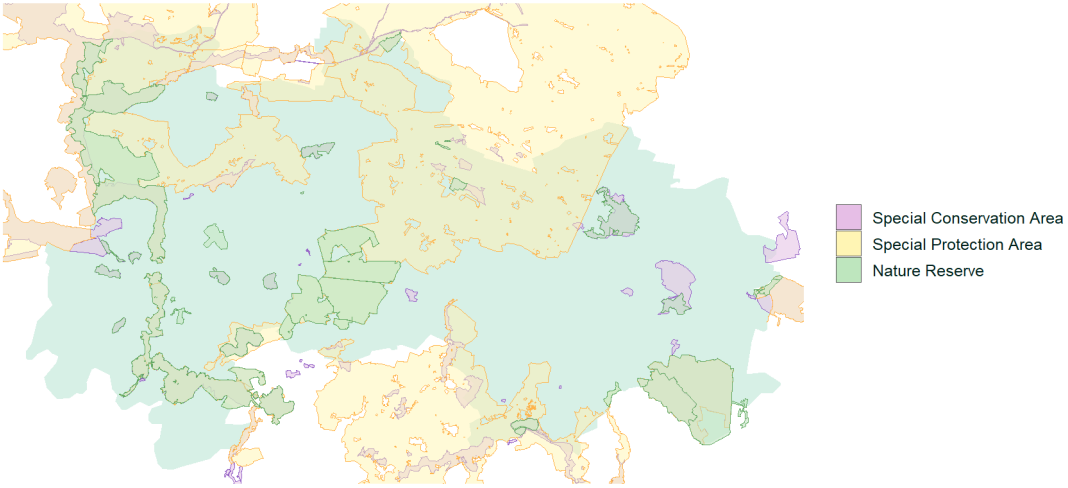


Figure 9: Map showing Protected Areas in the Havelland Living Lab (Data: Protected areas (BfN, 2019/2023))

Conservation sites intersecting this Living Lab region. Full polygon boundaries are shown, so sites extend beyond the region outline and designations may overlap. Source: BfN (FFH and bird sanctuaries 2019, nature reserves 2023) - not suitable for planning purposes.

Overview

Extensive glacial valleys dominate the landscape of the Havelland. Plateaus (such as the Nauener Plateau) rise from these valleys like islands, most of which are topped by ground moraines. Extensive meadows in the lowlands contrast with farmland and forests on the higher elevations (so-called “Ländchen”). The mosaic-like juxtaposition of island-like plateaus and extensive lowland stretches defines the character of this natural region. The mostly gently undulating plateaus stand out clearly from the surrounding lowlands.

Challenges

The farms in the Havelland region—some of which date back to the GDR era—have led to the development of large-scale field units; these tend to go hand in hand with the emergence of monocultures and weaken the resilience of landscapes. From a resilience perspective, greater landscape structuring should be pursued. In many places, the infrastructure for regulating water levels in the landscape is not intact.